



PL-7008

Create agents in Microsoft Copilot Studio

PL-7008 Course schedule

Introduction

1. Get started with Microsoft Copilot Studio
2. Design agent conversations using topics in Microsoft Copilot Studio
3. Build intelligent agents in Microsoft Copilot Studio
4. Add structured automation to agents in Microsoft Copilot Studio

1.

Get started with Microsoft Copilot Studio

Learning Objectives

After completing this module, you will be able to:

- 1** Create agents
- 2** Work with topics and generative AI
- 3** Understand Copilot Studio experience and harness options

Microsoft Learn module

Get started with Microsoft Copilot Studio

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/training/modules/power-virtual-agents-bots/>

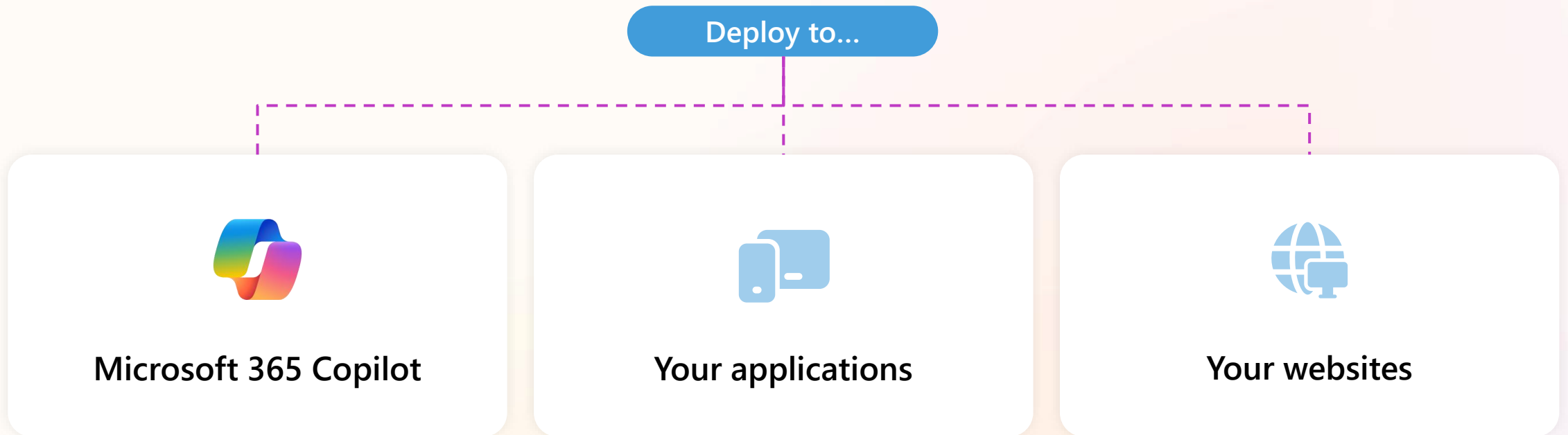


Introduction to Microsoft Copilot Studio agents

Get started with Microsoft Copilot Studio

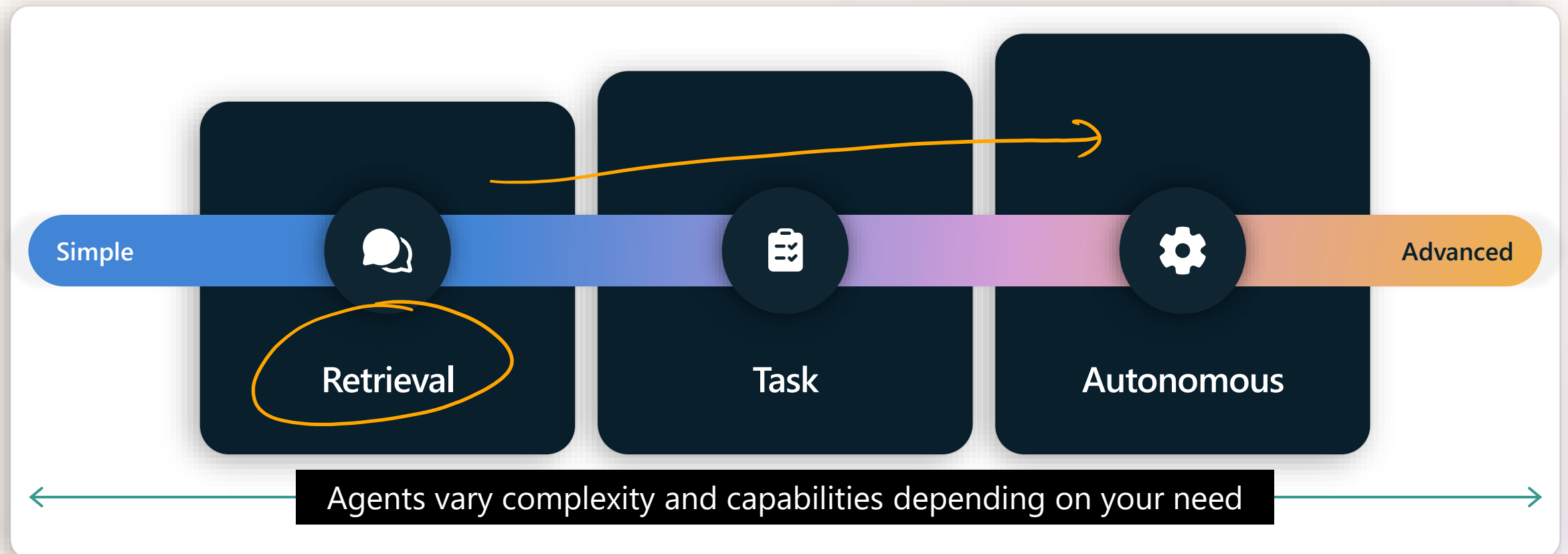
What is an agent?

- Agents use AI **to automate and execute business processes**, working alongside or on behalf of a person, team, or organization.



What is an agent?

Agents are programs that use AI to automate and execute business processes, working alongside or on behalf of a person, team or organization



Explore a continuum of agent solutions

A2A

Eliza

IT Helpdesk agent

How do I connect to the corporate network?



Device Refresh agent

Request a new laptop and send approvals via IT Service tool.



Lead Gen agent

The agent has identified and researched 15 new leads for you to review.



Simple



Advanced

Project Tracker agent

What is the status of phase 2 for project X and the remaining budget?



Budget Management agent

Review outstanding open PO's and begin financial planning.



Customer Support agent

The agent has identified new support issues and triaged to other agents.



Why do we need agents?



Growing number of communication channels

Need consistent messaging



Streamlined workforces

Higher workloads,
capacity constraints,
time-starved employees



Higher customer/ colleague demands

Greater urgency,
higher expectations, and
decreased satisfaction



Achieve more with automation through conversation



**Optimize digital
workforce**



**Faster time
to value**

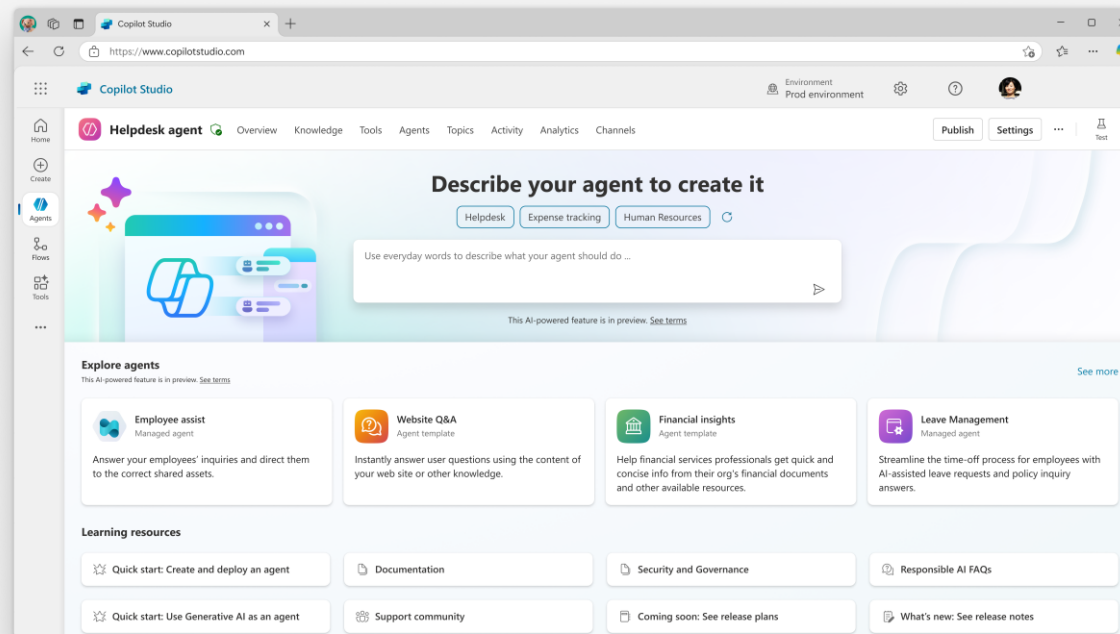


**More time for
innovation**



Microsoft Copilot Studio

Copilot Studio is a low code tool for **building agents and extending Microsoft 365 Copilot**



✔ Meet your users where they already are

✔ Access everything in one place

✔ Automate your workflows

✔ Integrate with your external apps

✔ Connect to your data in Microsoft 365

Microsoft Copilot Studio

Build your own agent

Create and publish a custom agent for your organization using the intuitive building experience enhanced with large language models and generative AI

Customize Microsoft Copilot

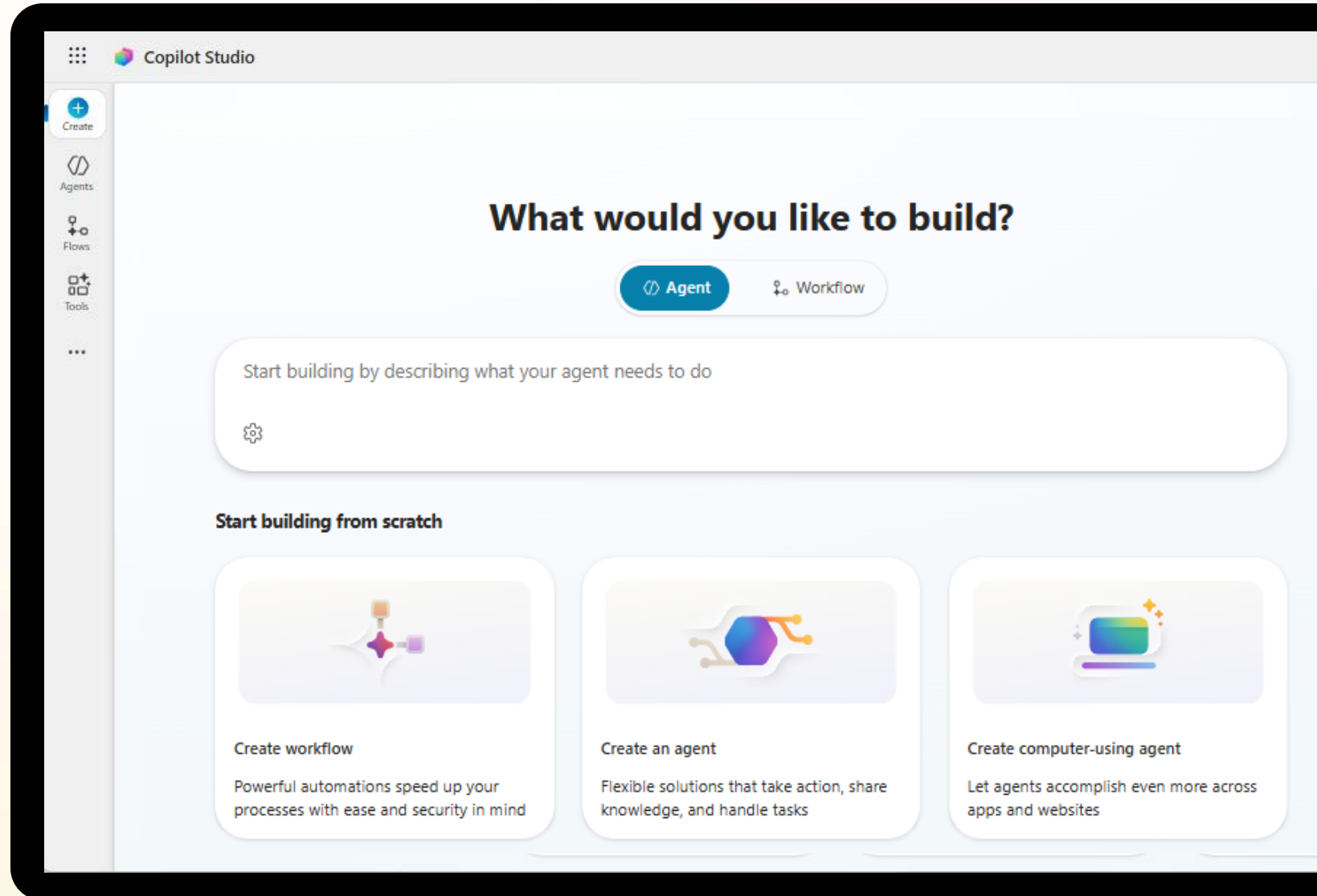
Extend and customize first-party Microsoft Copilot experiences with your own enterprise scenarios

Connected platform

Integrates and exposes various Microsoft's conversational AI technology stacks - integrated with Microsoft Foundry, Azure AI services, Power Platform AI models and more

Manage agent experiences

Governance and control features to monitor usage with full visibility of customizations, standalone agents as well as who is building and customizing them.



Microsoft Copilot Studio

HELPS YOU TO

- 01 Better empower your teams
- 02 Reduce costs
- 03 Improve customer satisfaction

USE CASES

- 1 Sales help and support issues
- 2 Opening hours and store information
- 3 Employee health and vacation benefits
- 4 Public health tracking information
- 5 Common employee questions for businesses

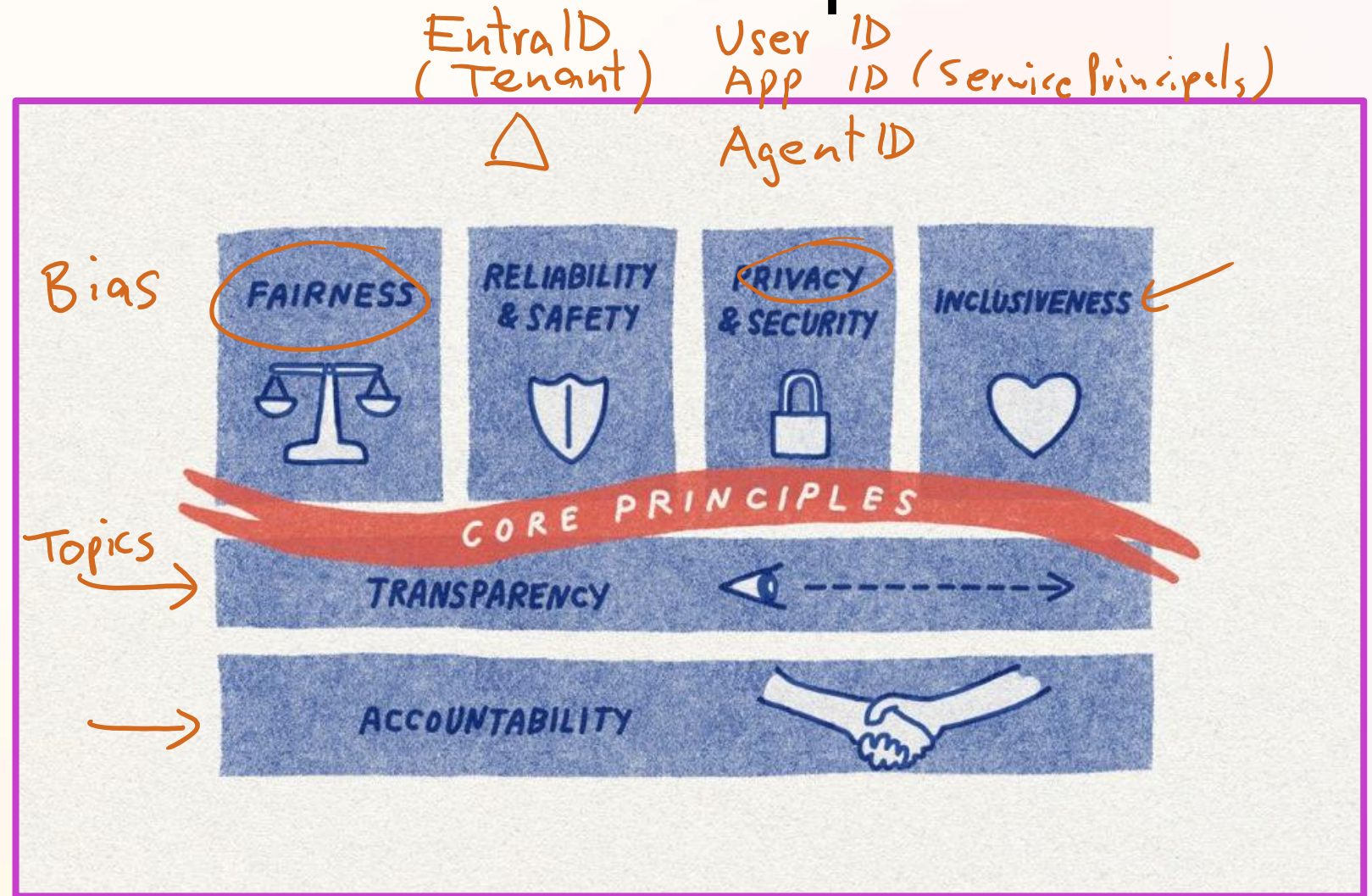
Examine how Microsoft is committed to responsible AI

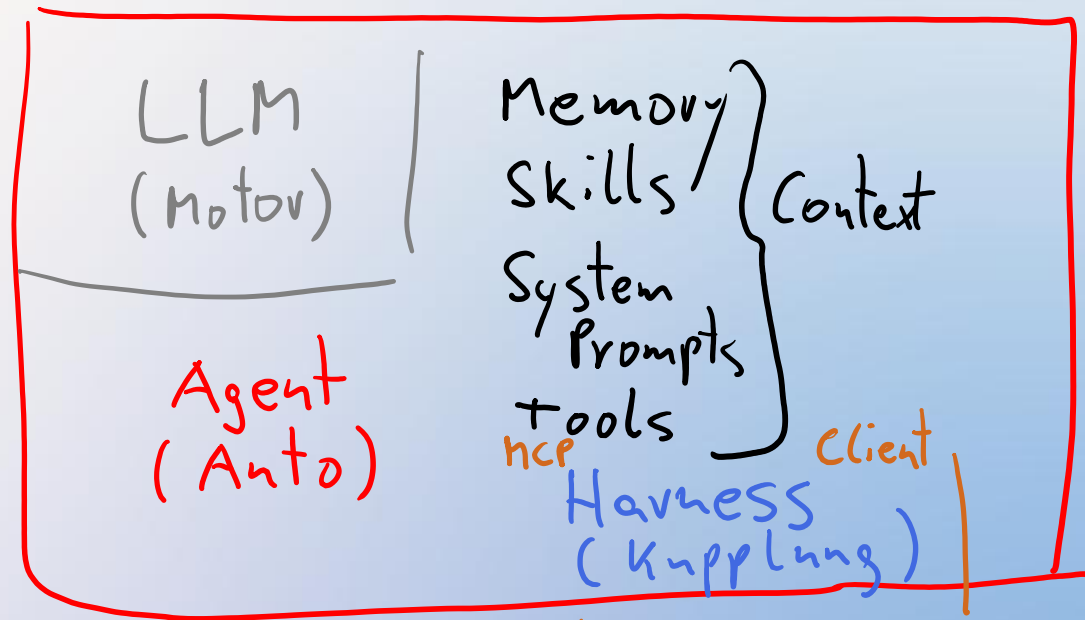
Microsoft integrates AI into its operations with a strong emphasis on ethics and responsibility

Microsoft harnesses a blend of:

- Ethical AI principles
- Compliance standards for responsible AI
- Comprehensive AI research, including privacy-centric machine learning

Microsoft's mission is to make AI systems trustworthy and empower customers for responsible AI use





- LLM
- Model Router
- SLM
- Multi Modal

Choose an experience and harness

- Index MCP Server
- Data
- DB
- API



Experience = where you author
 Harness = how the agent runs

Copilot Studio supports three agent harnesses

Harness: the runtime that decides when to call the model, which components to provide, and which tools to invoke.

Standard harness

COURSE FOCUS

- **You design:** topics, triggers, nodes, and branches
- **The agent follows:** conversation paths you author
- **Best for:** rule-based agents and agent flows
- **Typical starting point:** classic experience or Other ways to build

GitHub Copilot harness

Default Credits

- **You design:** instructions, skills, tools, and workflows
- **The agent follows:** a plan it reasons out toward your goal
- **Best for:** reasoning-heavy, multi-step work
- **Typical starting point:** new experience in Copilot Studio

Copilot chat harness

You extend: Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat

With: your organization's knowledge

Best for: organization-specific assistance in Microsoft 365

Typical starting point: Copilot Studio—create an agent for Microsoft 365 Copilot

Key takeaway: Choose the harness based on how the agent needs to work—not where you start building.

Power Platform Environments

Sources: Microsoft Learn, Choose a harness; Microsoft Agent Academy (accessed Aug. 6, 2026)

Classic vs. new agent experience

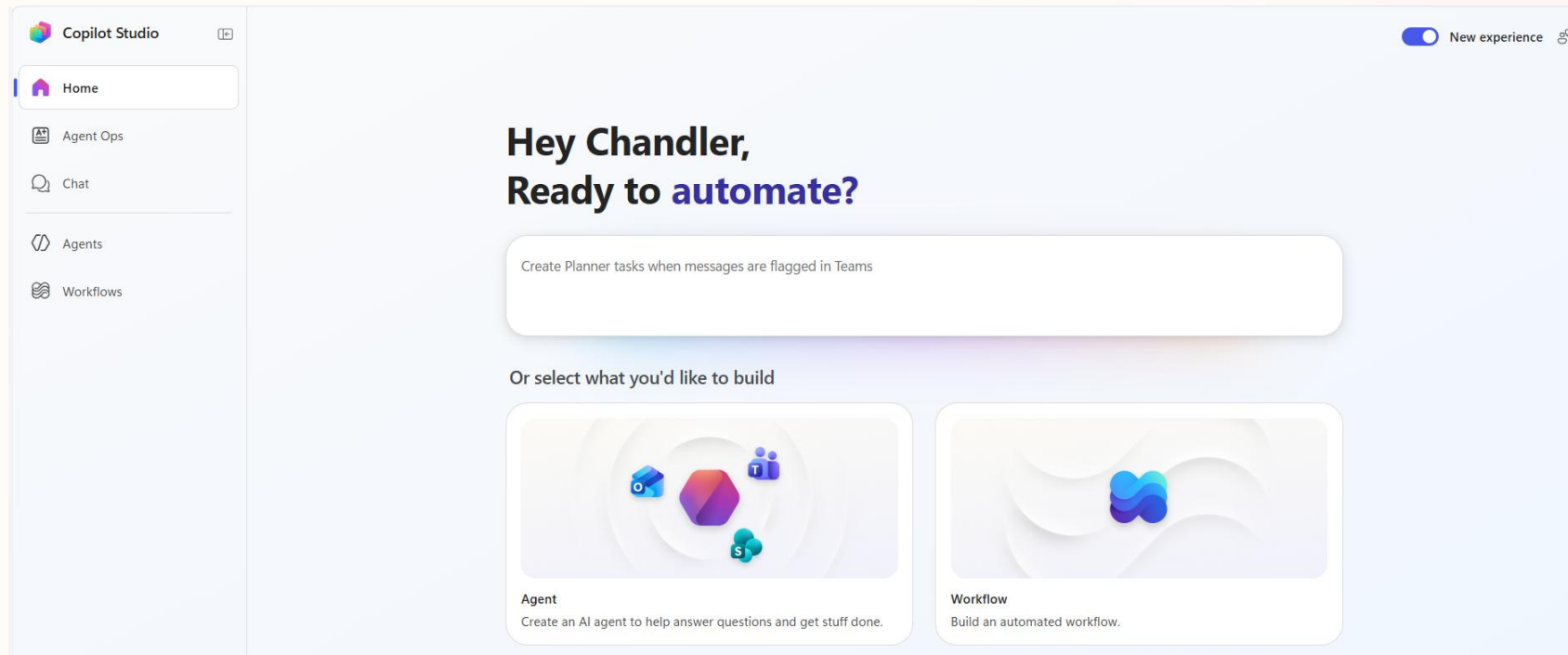
Classic experience

- Authoring is organized around topics, flows, branching logic, and explicit configuration nodes
- The canvas is the primary authoring surface, with separate sections for topics, knowledge, actions, and settings
- Agent behavior relies on explicit topic triggers and conversation design
- Orchestration is configurable, with options for classic or generative modes

New agent experience

- Authoring starts with a natural language description of the agent's purpose and behavior
- One build surface replaces the separate authoring sections
- An enhanced orchestration runtime plans the response instead of matching trigger phrases
- Skills, tools, knowledge, connected agents, Microsoft IQ, and memory extend what the agent can do
- Some classic capabilities aren't available in the new experience yet

A look at the new agent experience



Choosing an experience

Select Try it now on the classic home page to open the new experience. Turn off New experience to switch back.

One build surface

Build, Preview, Evaluate, and Monitor replace the separate topics, tools, and settings sections.

Which authoring experience should makers use?

The authoring experience controls where you build; the harness controls how the agent runs:



Existing agents: stay in the classic experience to maintain or extend what you've already built, or when you need deterministic topic and trigger-based control.



New agents: start in the new experience when natural language authoring, planning-based orchestration, and reusable skills add value.



No migration path: currently, an agent created in one experience can't be converted to the other, so decide before you build.

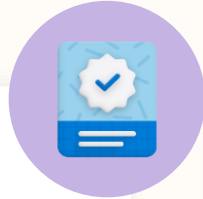


In this course: the core labs use the classic experience and standard harness.

Work with environments

Get started with Microsoft Copilot Studio

Create environments



Default environment

- Default environment created when signing in.
- Agents created in the default environment.
- Specify otherwise to create agents in different environments.



Adding more environments

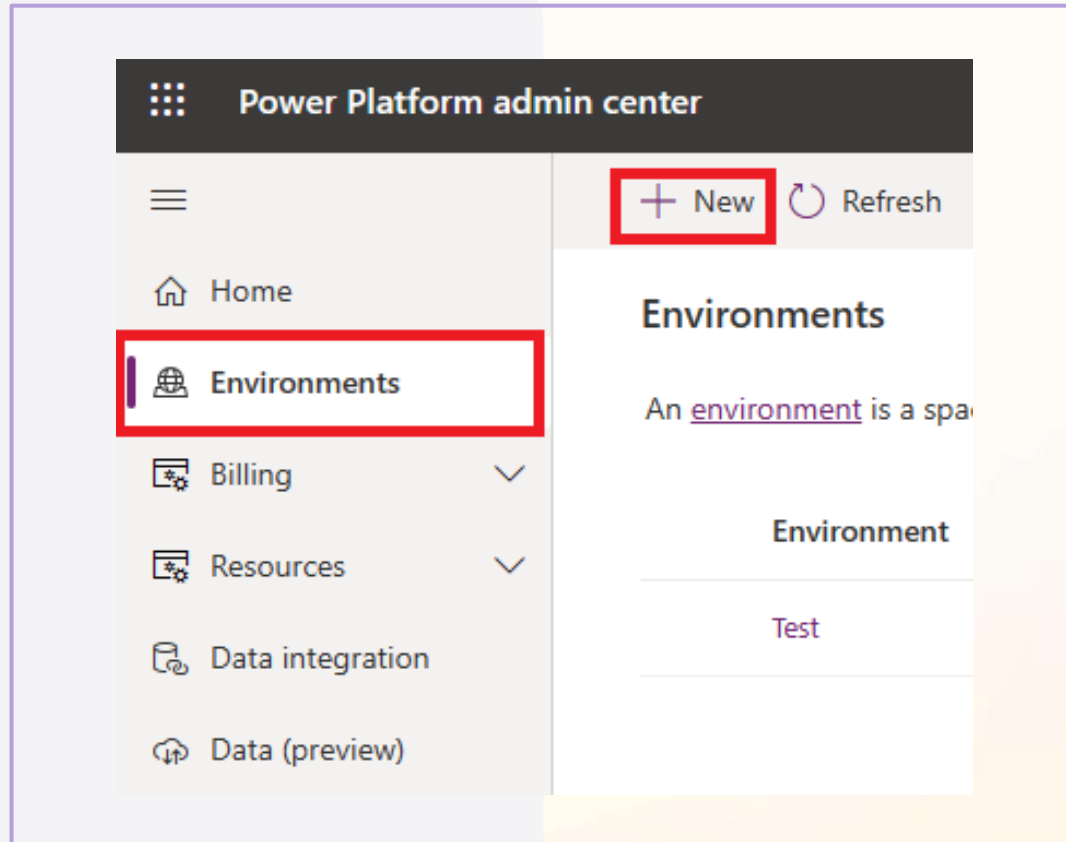
- Add more environments for different regions.
- Organizational needs or other circumstances.
- Use Microsoft Power Platform admin center.



Microsoft Power Platform admin center

- For more information, see creating environments.
- Establish environments for each region.
- Use and store data for customers in that region.

Environments in Microsoft Copilot Studio

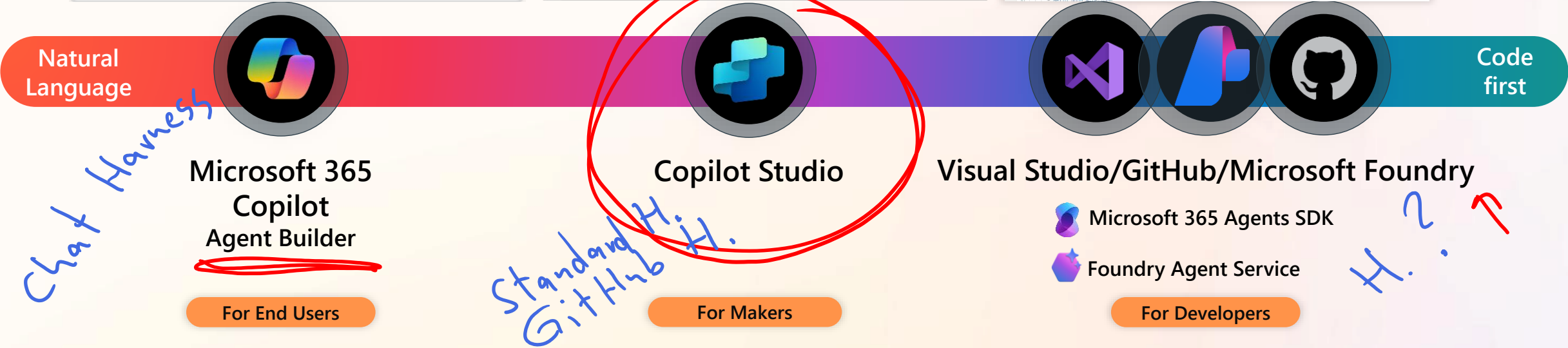
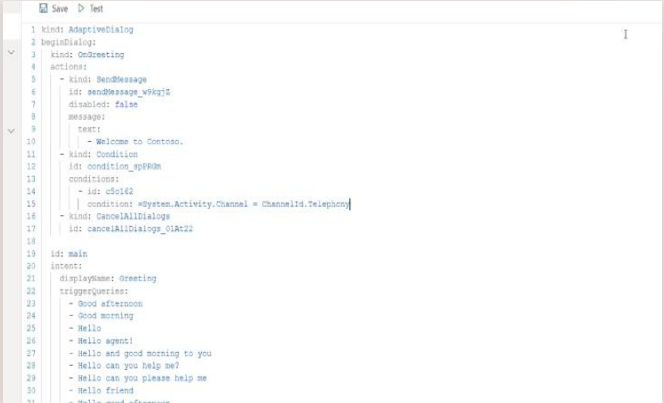
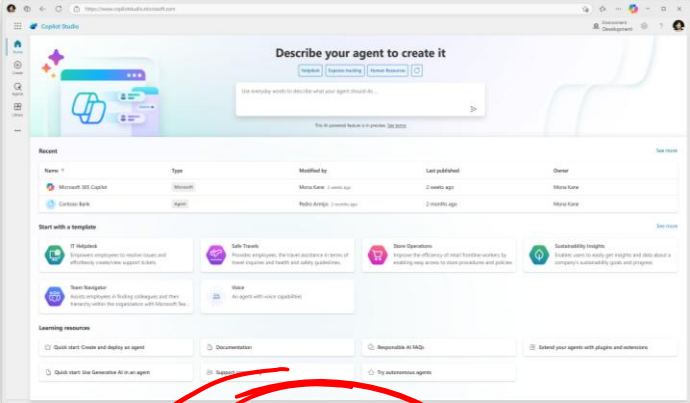
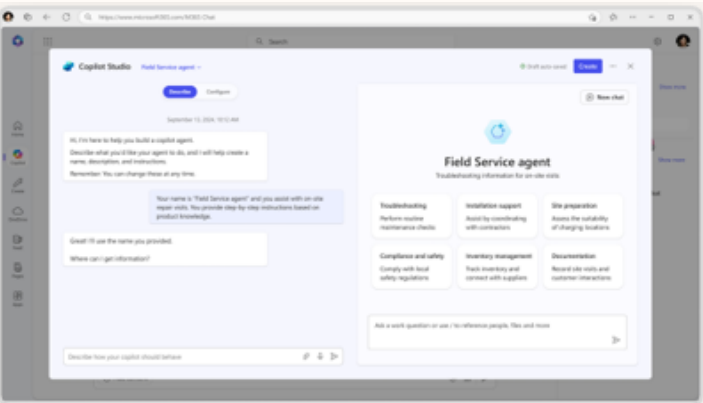


- Environments are containers for your agents, apps, flows, and business data
- Each environment can have its own roles, security requirements, and audience
- Align environments to departments, regions, or business needs
- Global organizations use separate environments to meet data privacy requirements
- Add more environments as new needs and regions emerge
- Create and manage environments in the Power Platform admin center

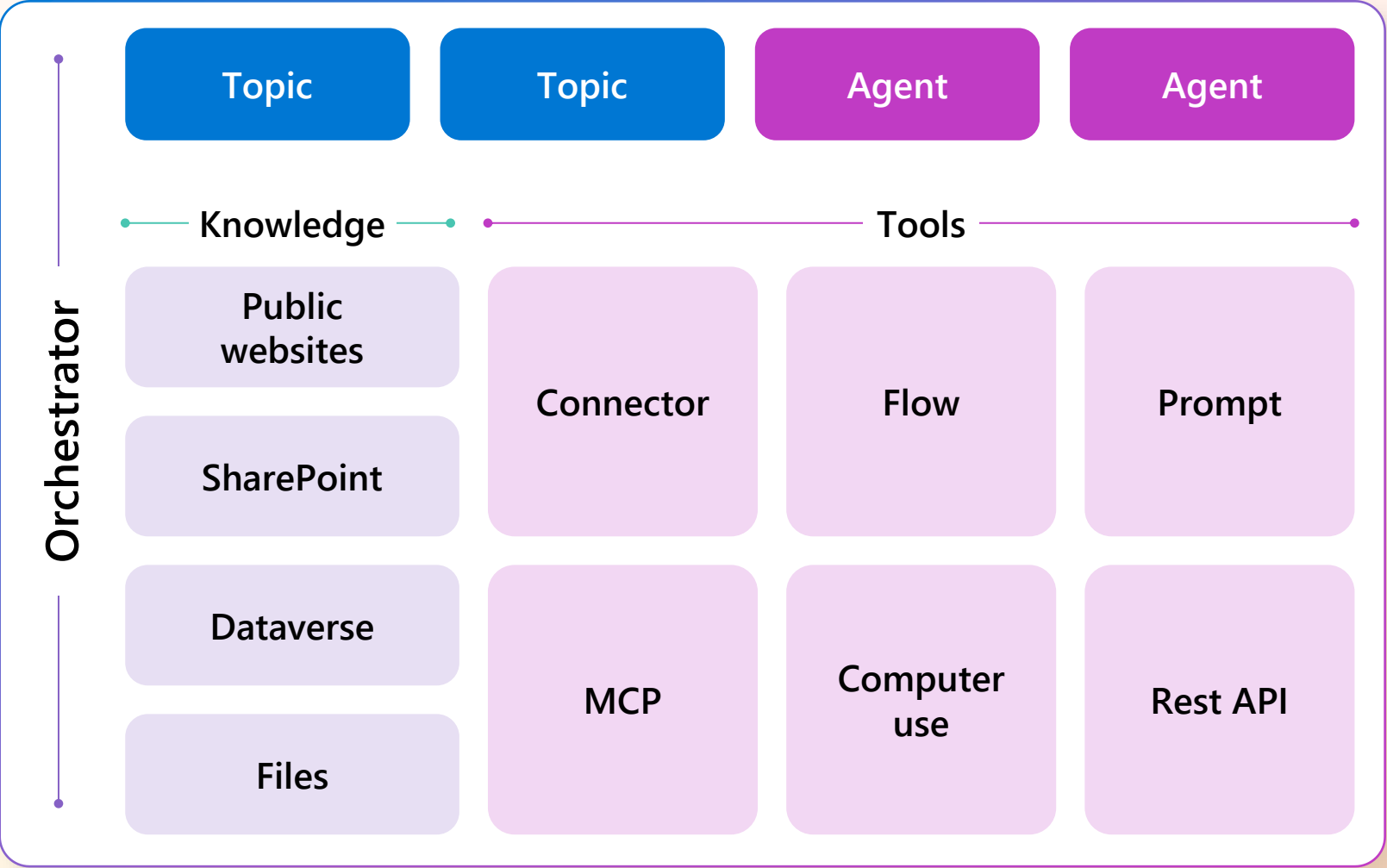
Agent building

Ways to build agents with Microsoft

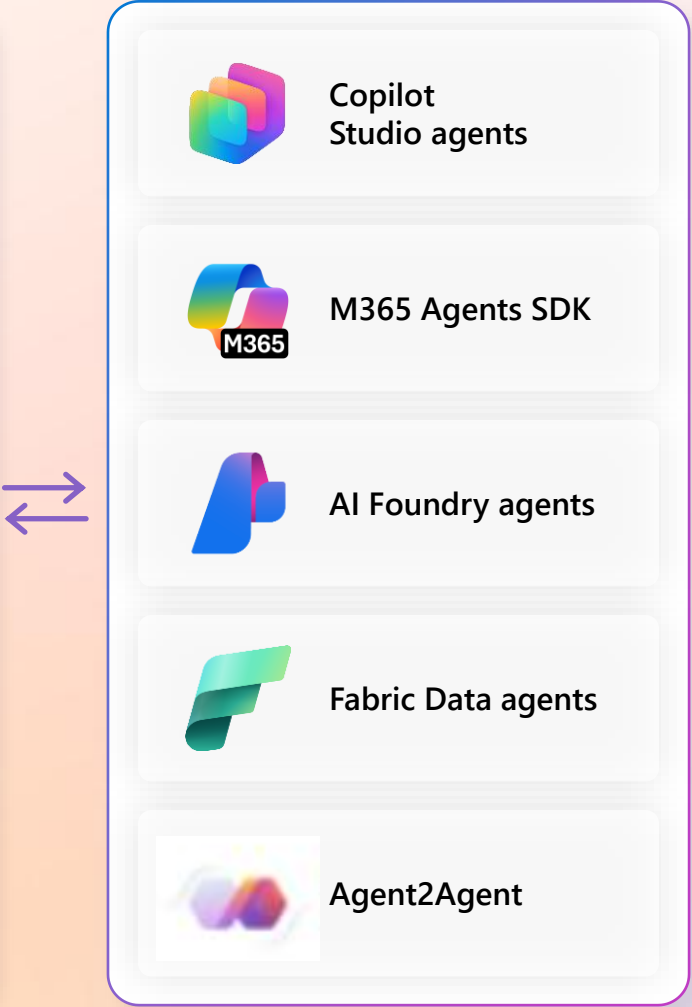
Agent development tools



Copilot Studio agent



Connected agents



Microsoft 365 Copilot (Agent Builder)

Declarative agents

- Answer questions using your team's documents, emails, SharePoint, or OneDrive content
- Provide consistent, approved answers for small teams or individual use
- Require no code and are designed for everyday information workers

Describe

Configure

Template: ⓘ None ▼

Details



Name

New Agent

Description ⓘ

Describe your agent

Instructions ⓘ

Describe what this agent should do, define its tone, and outline any rules or guidelines it must follow

Microsoft Copilot Studio

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Copilot Studio interface for an agent named "Expense Claim Assistant". The top navigation bar includes "Home", "Agents", "Flows", "Tools", and a menu icon. The main header shows the agent name and a search icon. The "Overview" tab is selected, displaying the agent's details, description, model selection, and triggers. The "Test your agent" tab is also visible on the right.

Expense Claim Assistant Overview Knowledge Tools Agents Topics Activity Evaluation Analytics Channels

Details Edit

Name
Expense Claim Assistant

Description 75/1024
Helps employees submit, track, and manage their expense claims efficiently.

Select your agent's model
Your agent will primarily use the model for reasoning and responding. Experimental models are subject to [preview terms](#). [Learn more](#)

GPT-4.1 (Default)

Triggers + Add trigger
Set up your agent to activate when certain events happen. [Learn more](#)

Test your agent

Copilot Studio agents

- Run multi-step workflows
- Use topics for guided conversations.
- Integrate with business systems via connectors, APIs, and automation.
- Use knowledge, tools, and generative orchestration.

Copilot Studio agents are best for

- Department or organization-wide agents
- Customer-facing agents
- Agents requiring compliance, governance, analytics
- Process agents that perform actions, gather data, or automate tasks

Microsoft Foundry

Microsoft Foundry creates AI-engineered, code-first agents with full control over

- AI model selection and fine-tuning
- Data orchestration and pipelines
- Tool invocation
- Complex multi-agent or autonomous workflows
- Security, compliance, and custom infrastructure
- Integration with cloud systems and applications

e.com/resource/agents?wsid=/subscriptions/90dcf2d4-2bc6-4da8-baf3-389456d9629e/resourceGroups/rg-User1-5158

isesagent / Playgrounds / Agents playground

← Agents playground

+ New agent </> View code Delete Create trigger PREVIEW

Thread: thread_0lbz8Rbbvmp8obVTm2hTxdHP 3863t Thread info

What's the maximum I can claim?

The maximum claimable amount for meals is \$50 per day, and it applies to breakfast, lunch, and dinner combined. It's important to select reasonably priced dining options and avoid alcoholic beverages or excessive spending ¹.

1 Expenses_Policy.docx

2s 2390t AI quality 5 View Run Info

Type user query here. (Shift + Enter for new line)

Messages in the Agents playground are visible to anyone with access to this resource and using the API.

Setup

Agent id asst_xc

Agent na Expens

Deploym gpt-4o

Instructio

You are corpor You an about the exp ..

> Agen

Know (1)

Why you should build agents with Copilot Studio

Copilot Studio is the right choice when you need more than a simple Q&A agent—you need a reliable, secure, powerful agent that can automate real business processes.



Build more powerful, flexible agents



Designed for enterprise-wide deployment



Deep integration with business systems and data



Strong governance, security, and lifecycle management

Declarative agents

Get started with Microsoft Copilot Studio

Declarative agents

The screenshot displays the Microsoft Agent Store interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation options: 'Agents' (with sub-items: Researcher, Analyst, Italian Language Tutor, Idea Coach, Project Status Summarizer), 'All agents' (highlighted), 'Create agent' (highlighted with a red box), 'Conversations', and 'Library'. The main area is titled 'Agent Store' with the subtitle 'Find agents with the expertise to help you complete complex tasks'. Below this is a search bar labeled 'Search agents'. Under the 'Your agents' section, a grid of agent cards is shown, including Researcher, Analyst, Italian Language Tutor, Idea Coach, Project Status Summarizer, Microsoft Certification..., Teams Meeting Analyzer, and Foundry Governance A...

Declarative agents can be created using:
Agent Builder inside Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat
SharePoint
Copilot Studio

- Install a managed agent
- Create a declarative agent from a template
- Create a declarative agent with natural language (Describe)
- Create a blank declarative agent (Configure)

Enhance a declarative agent

- Instructions
- Knowledge
- Capabilities

When responding:

- Greet the customer warmly.
- Answer their questions based on Contoso Coffee's Official Return Policy.
- If a question is outside your knowledge or needs escalation, politely inform the customer and direct them to the Contoso Coffee website.
- Offer additional help before ending the conversation.

Always aim to make the customer feel heard, valued, and supported.

Knowledge

Choose the sources your agent will use to generate responses

Add files, meetings, chats, emails, and websites 



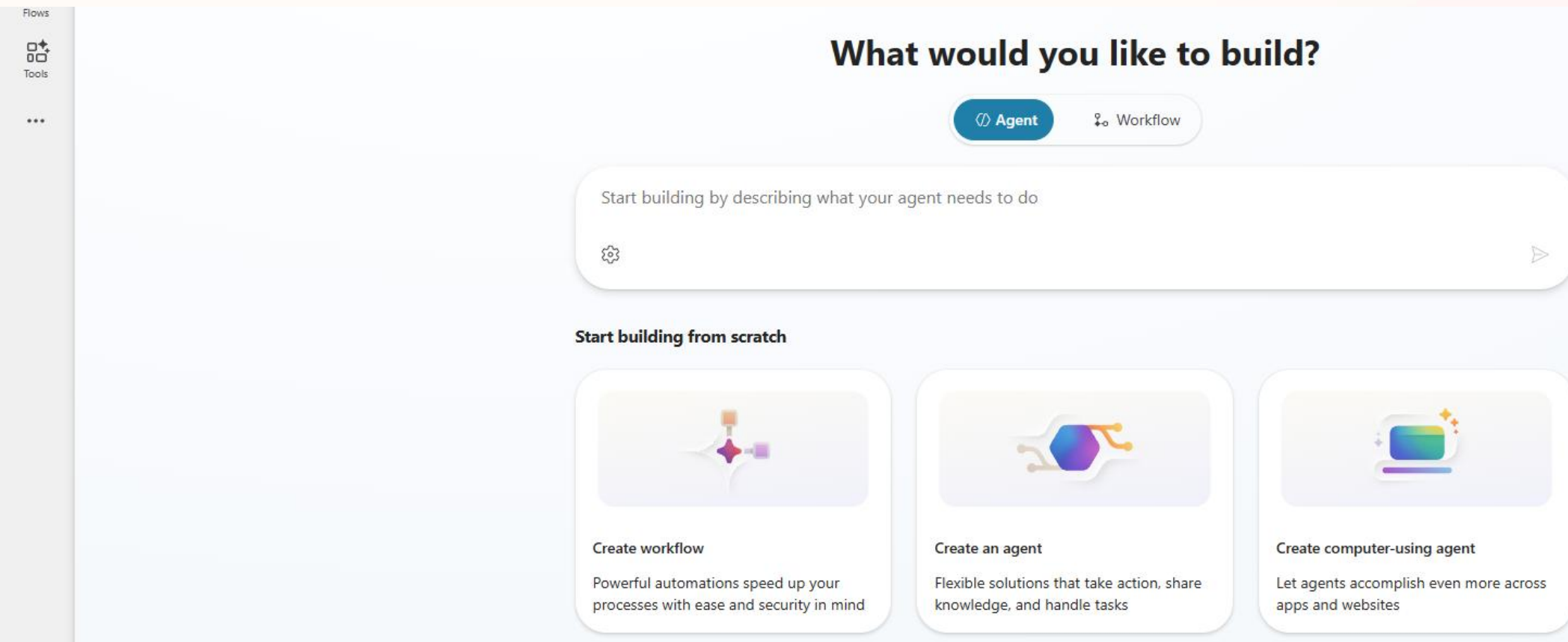
Enter a URI or name or drop files here



Create and configure agents in Microsoft Copilot Studio

Get started with Microsoft Copilot Studio

Create and configure agents in Microsoft Copilot Studio



- Install a managed agent
- Create an agent from a template
- Create an agent with natural language
- Create a blank agent

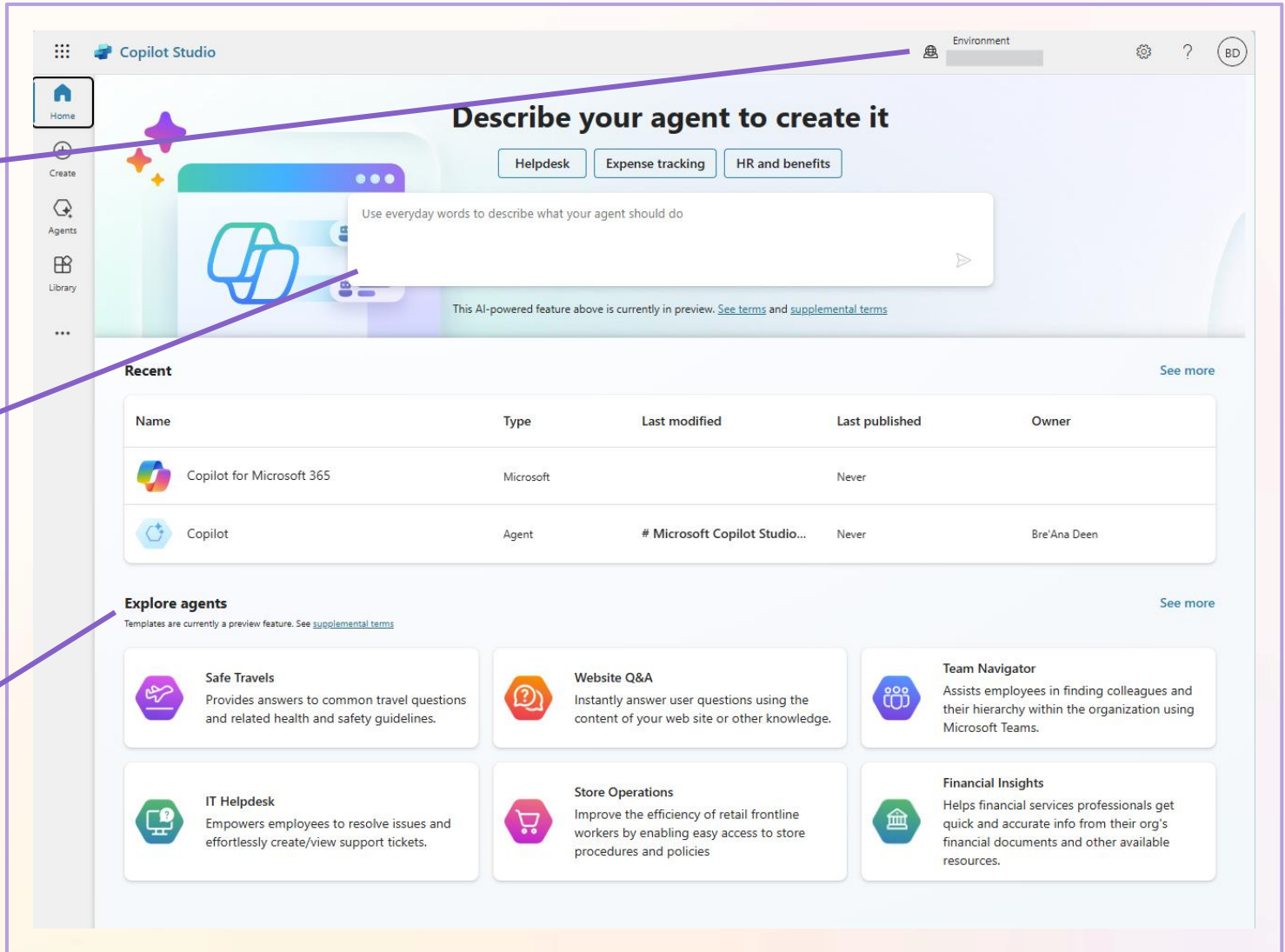
Create and configure agents in Microsoft Copilot Studio

Select the *environment* in which to create the agent

Describe the desired agent features and capabilities in a chat interface

or

Select a template for common agent implementations



Key concepts

Predefined paths that orchestrate the flow of conversational dialogs

Topics



Data sources searched by generative AI to create relevant responses

Knowledge



Automated tasks that can be initiated by an agent

Tools



Deployment options for making your published agent available to users

Channels



Metrics and data to assess agent performance and user satisfaction

Analytics



Agent creation using natural language

Settings

- Primary language
- Solution
- Schema name

Agent settings

×

These settings can only be updated before the creation of the agent

Agent's language

Manage the language your agent uses to communicate

Language

English (United States) ▾

Advanced settings

Solution * ⓘ

Bookings ▾

Schema name * ⓘ

contoso_

Update

Cancel



Name

Copilot Studio Agent Guide

Description

85/1024

Helps users understand and learn how to create agents using Microsoft Copilot Studio.

Select your agent's model

Your agent will primarily use the model for reasoning and responding. Experimental models are subject to [preview terms](#). [Learn more](#)

GPT-4.1 (Default)



Triggers

+ Add trigger

Set up your agent to activate when certain events happen. [Learn more](#).

Suggestion:  When a row is added, modified or deleted

+ Add X Dismiss

Suggestion:  When an email is flagged (V4)

+ Add X Dismiss

Suggestion:  When an email is flagged (V3)

+ Add X Dismiss

Populated on create:

- Name
- Description
- Instructions

Suggestions added for:

- Triggers
- Knowledge
- Tools

Agent instructions

WHAT INSTRUCTIONS HELP THE AGENT DO

01

Choose resources

Decide what resources (tools, knowledge, topics, or other agents) to call to address a user query or autonomous trigger

02

Prepare the tool

Fill inputs for any tool based on the available context

03

Respond

Generate a response to the end user

CRAFT INSTRUCTIONS

ROLE

What's the purpose of the agent?

SCOPE

What should it do? What should it avoid?

CONTEXT

What does the agent need to know?

TONE

How should the agent respond?

ERROR HANDLING

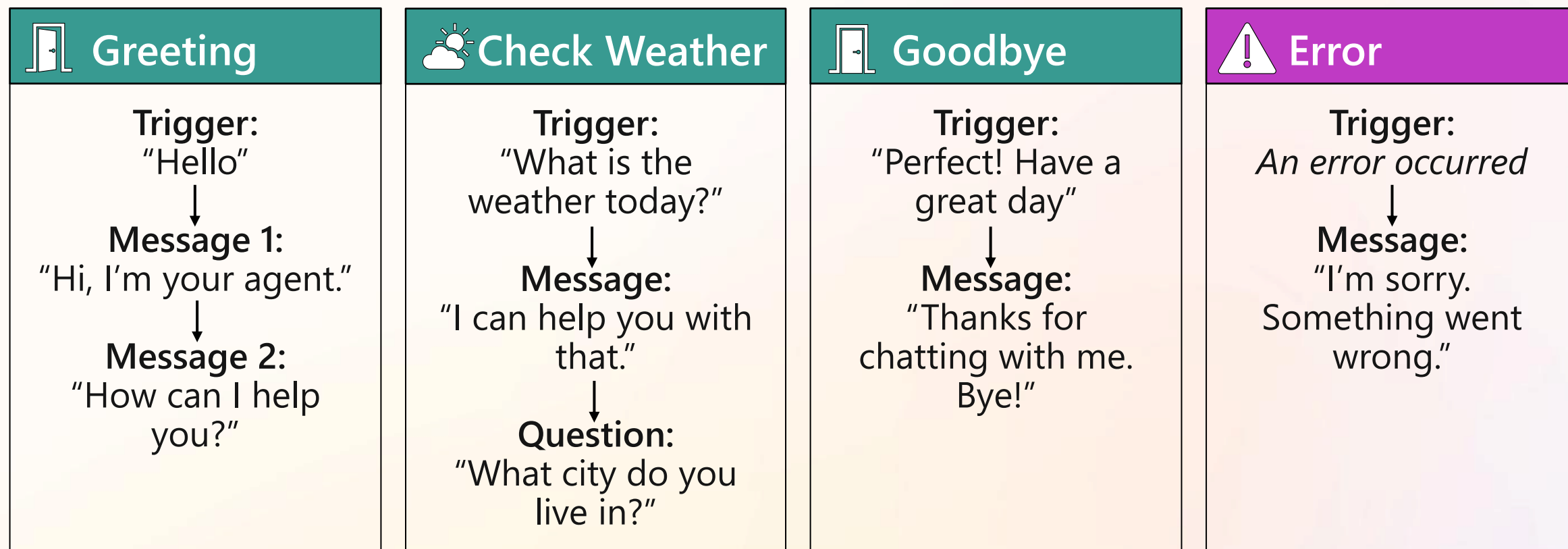
What does it do if it's unsure?

Work with topics

Get started with Microsoft Copilot Studio

Topics in Copilot Studio

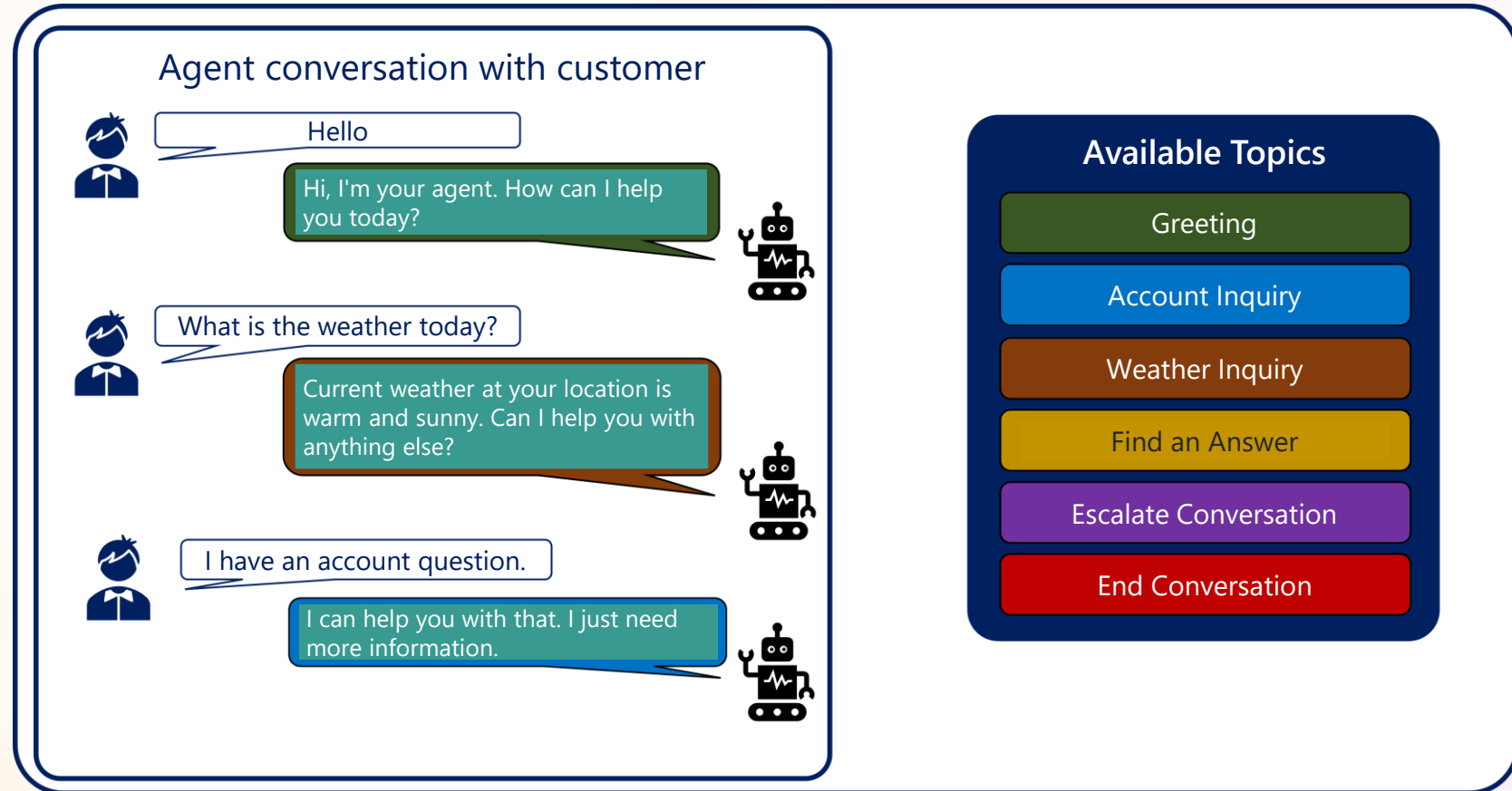
- **Topics** define curated conversation flows
- **Generative orchestration** uses topic names and descriptions; **classic orchestration** uses trigger phrases
- **Topics** can also run through other trigger types or calls from another topic



Topics in Copilot Studio

Topics as conversations

- Each topic is a small individual conversation on a specific subject
- Multiple topics are used together in an agent to provide the customer with an automated conversation that feels natural
- Every agent includes built-in system topics; makers add custom topics as needed



System topics

Name	Trigger	Description	Editing	Last modified	Errors	Enabled
 Conversation Start	 On Con...	This system...		Lab Admin20 1 ho...		☒ On
 Conversational boosting	? Unkno...	Create gen...		Lab Admin20 1 ho...		☒ On
 End of Conversation	 On redi...	This system...		Lab Admin20 1 ho...		☒ On
 Escalate	 On Talk...	This system...		Lab Admin20 1 ho...		☒ On
 Fallback	? Unkno...	This system...		Lab Admin20 1 ho...		☒ On
 Multiple Topics Matched	 On select	This system...		Lab Admin20 1 ho...		☒ On

Built in and added automatically to every agent

- Cannot create or delete system topics
- Can turn off system topics you do not need
- Can edit system topics, including some trigger phrases

Create custom topics

- From blank
- From a description with Copilot

The screenshot shows a web interface with a sidebar on the left containing a list of topics: 'All', 'Custom', 'Goodbye', 'Greeting', 'Start Over', and 'Thank you'. The 'Custom' tab is selected. A modal dialog box titled 'Add from description with Copilot' is open. It contains the following elements:

- A close button (X) in the top right corner.
- Instructional text: 'Write a description of what you'd like your agent to cover, and Copilot will create your topic. [Learn more](#)'.
- A section titled 'Name your topic *' with a text input field containing 'Capture Customer details'.
- A section titled 'Create a topic to... *' with a text input field containing 'Capture the name and email address for a customer and ask the confirm their details using an adaptive card'.
- A disclaimer: 'AI-generated content can have mistakes. Make sure it's accurate and appropriate before using it. [Read terms](#)'.
- A section titled 'Or try one of these examples to get started' with three example cards, each starting with a lightbulb icon:
 - 'Let someone order a pizza, choosing from common pizza types and how many they want to order.'
 - 'Accept a user's name, age and date of birth and then repeat their responses back to them.'
 - 'Collect a user's street address, state and zip code. The user should be able to retry each question up to 4 times.'
- A link at the bottom left: '[What does Copilot support?](#)'.
- Buttons at the bottom right: 'View more examples' (with a refresh icon), 'Create' (in a blue button), and 'Cancel' (in a white button).

Enhancing productivity with Generative AI

Generative orchestration

Let your agent use AI to choose the best tools, knowledge, topics, and other agents to respond to queries or triggers

Handle variable, multi-step and conversational scenarios by dynamically adapting to user input and context

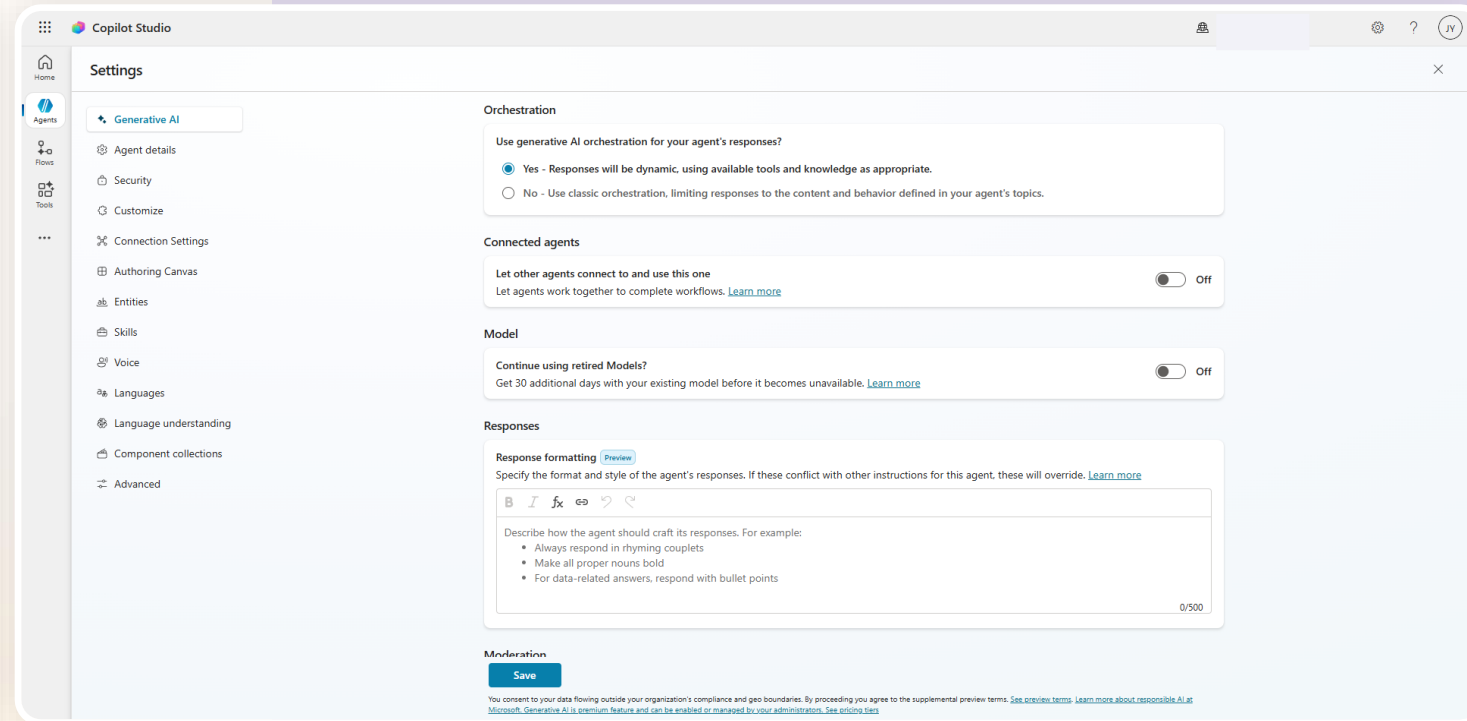
By default, newly created agents are configured to use generative orchestration

How it works

1. Detects user intent in real time
2. Selects and sequences the right tools, plugins, and knowledge sources
3. Executes actions and delivers personalized responses—no need to predefine every path

Key benefits

- ✓ Rapidly automate new scenarios without rebuilding flows
- ✓ Tailor responses and actions to each user and situation
- ✓ Less manual authoring, more scalable automation



Agent orchestration options

Generative orchestration

- **Chooses** topics, tools, knowledge, and other agents
- **Uses** names and descriptions to build a plan
- **Adapts** to flexible or multi-step requests

Classic orchestration

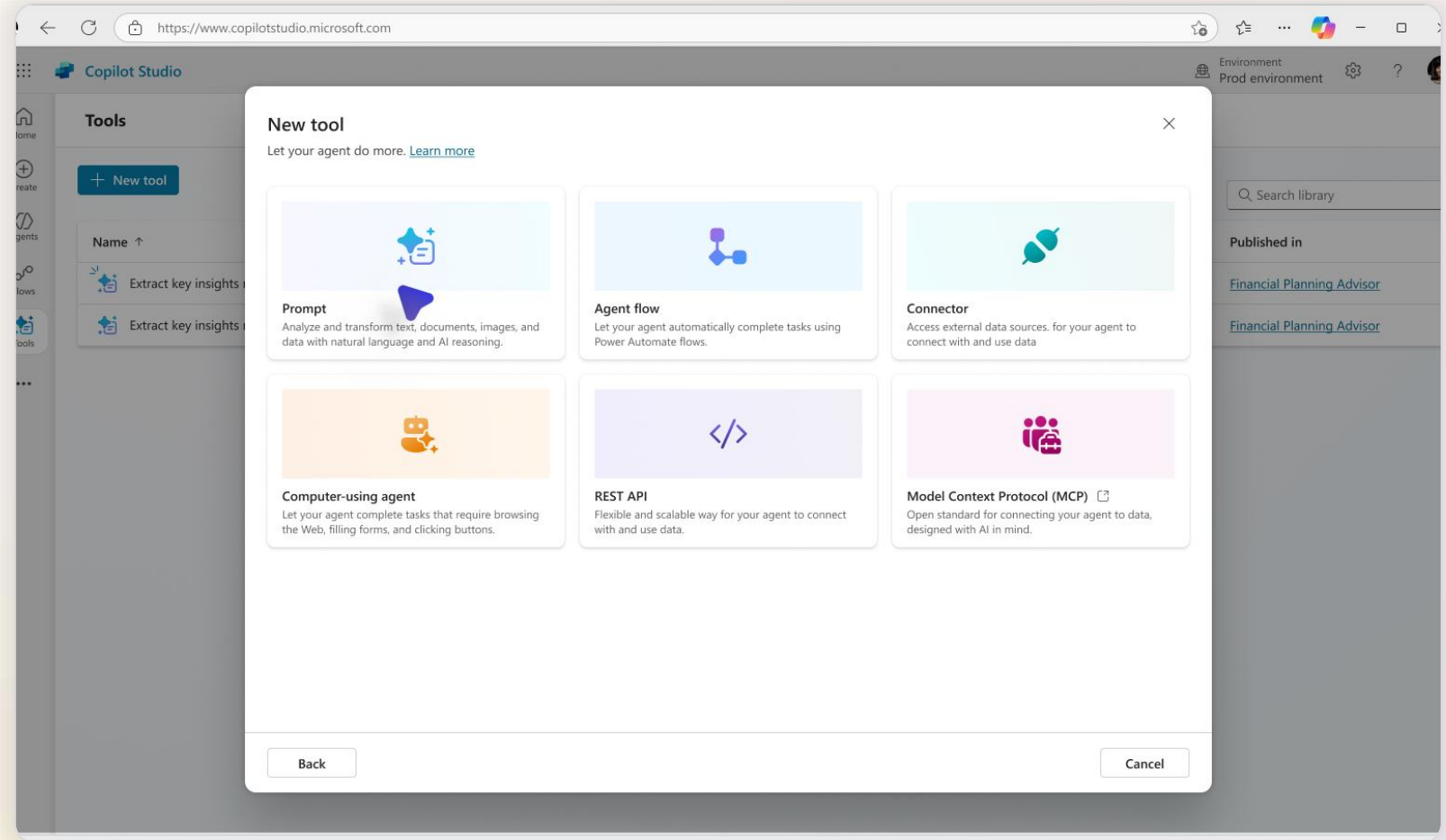
- **Chooses** one topic using trigger phrases
- **Calls** tools and knowledge from authored topics
- **Follows** predictable, controlled paths

New agents use generative orchestration by default.

Tools

Easily connect to your key line of business systems

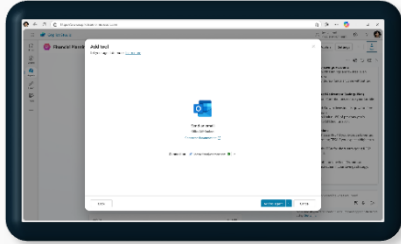
- Enable your agent to automate your business processes and complete tasks
- With generative orchestration, the agent decides which tool(s) to use



Tool types

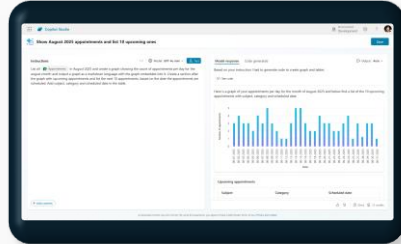
Tools are versatile and reusable components.

Create, manage and use tools across various agents within an environment.



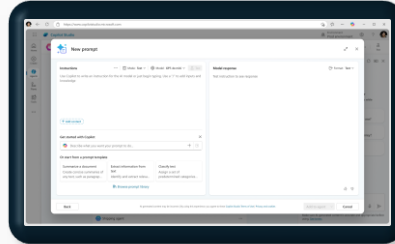
Connectors

Choose from **1400+** prebuilt Power Platform connectors, **100+ Copilot connectors** or create a **custom connector** for any public API to retrieve information, write/edit/update records to external services and data sources



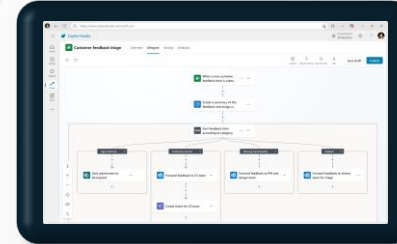
REST APIs

Use **APIs directly** for your agent to connect with and use data in the most flexible and scalable manner



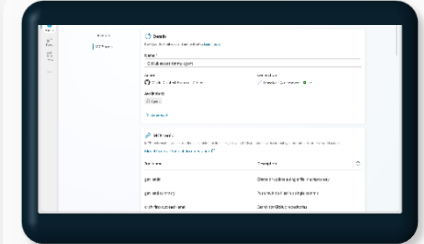
Prompts

Leverage **library** of prompts or draft **custom instructions** with Copilot to transform text, documents, images and data with LLMs



Agent Flows

Define **predictable automations** to run the same way each time, giving you more control over specific actions the agent could take, including allowing the agent to directly **use web and desktop apps** through UI automation



Model Context Protocol

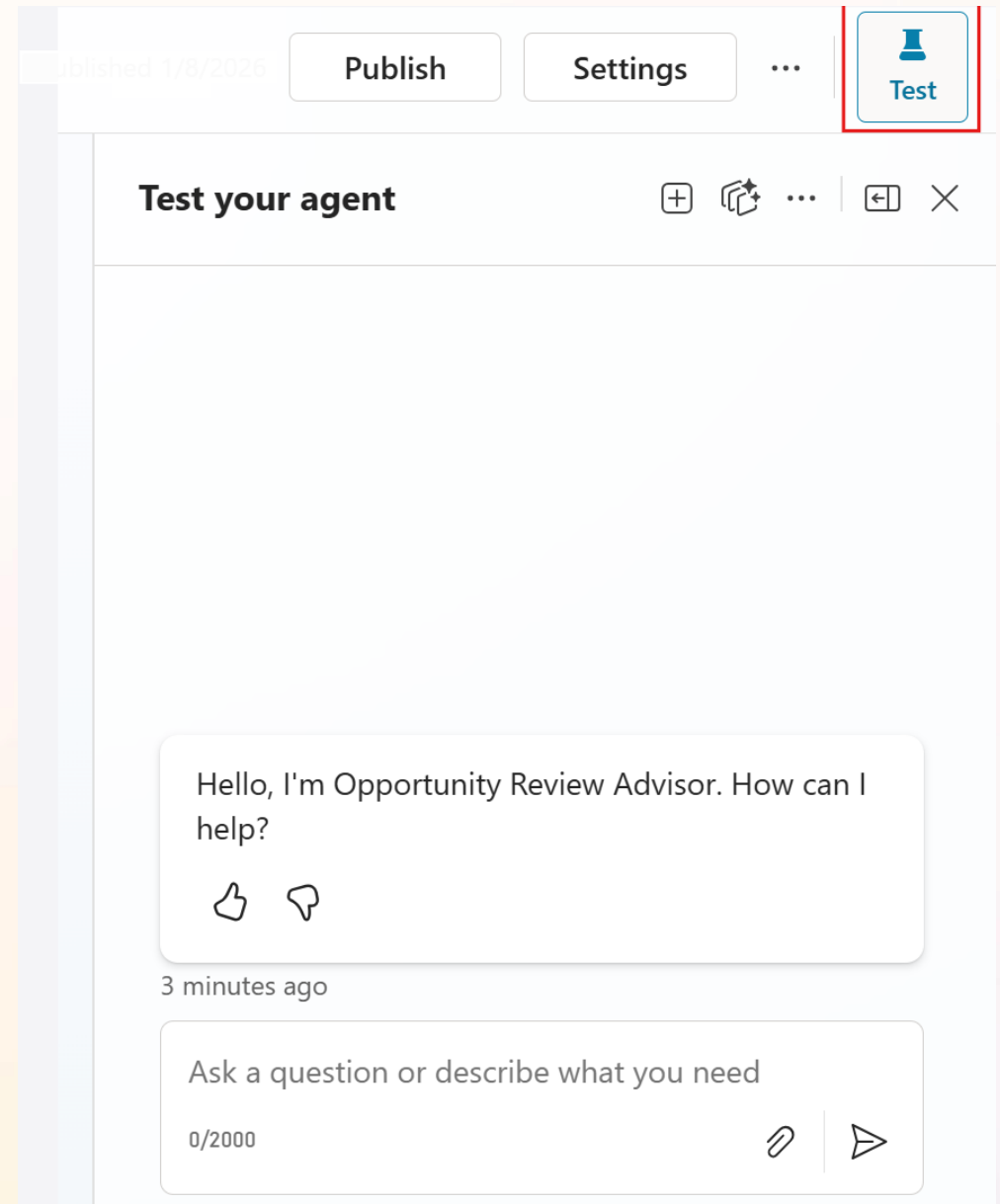
Use open standard protocol to **connect your LOB services** to the agent with adequate context and tools enabled by the servers

Test and deploy your agents

Test agent

Show and hide test panel by selecting Test button

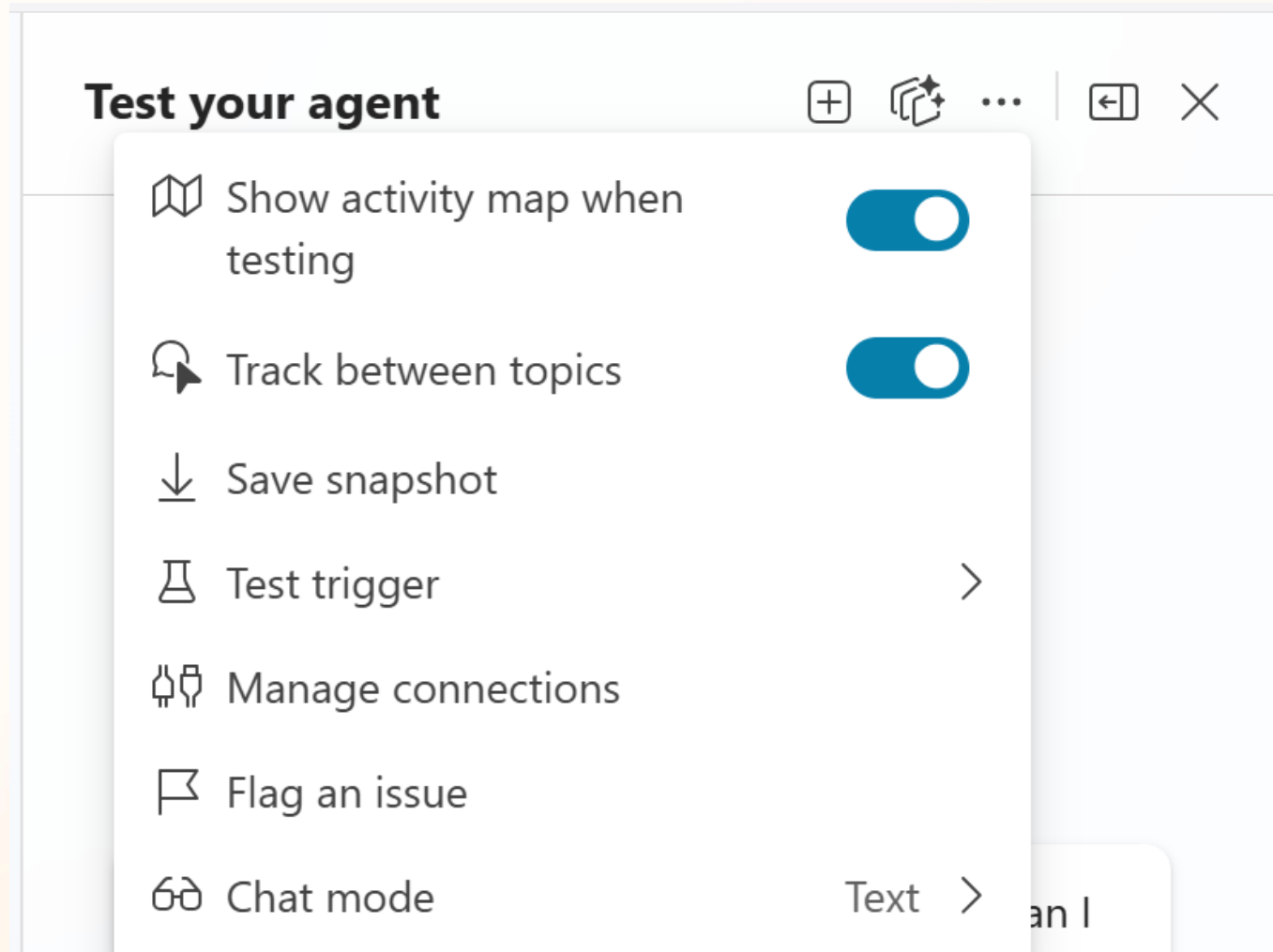
- Ask questions or describe what you need
- View the results



Test agent

Test panel options

- Activity map
- Track between topics
- Start a new test session



Security



No authentication



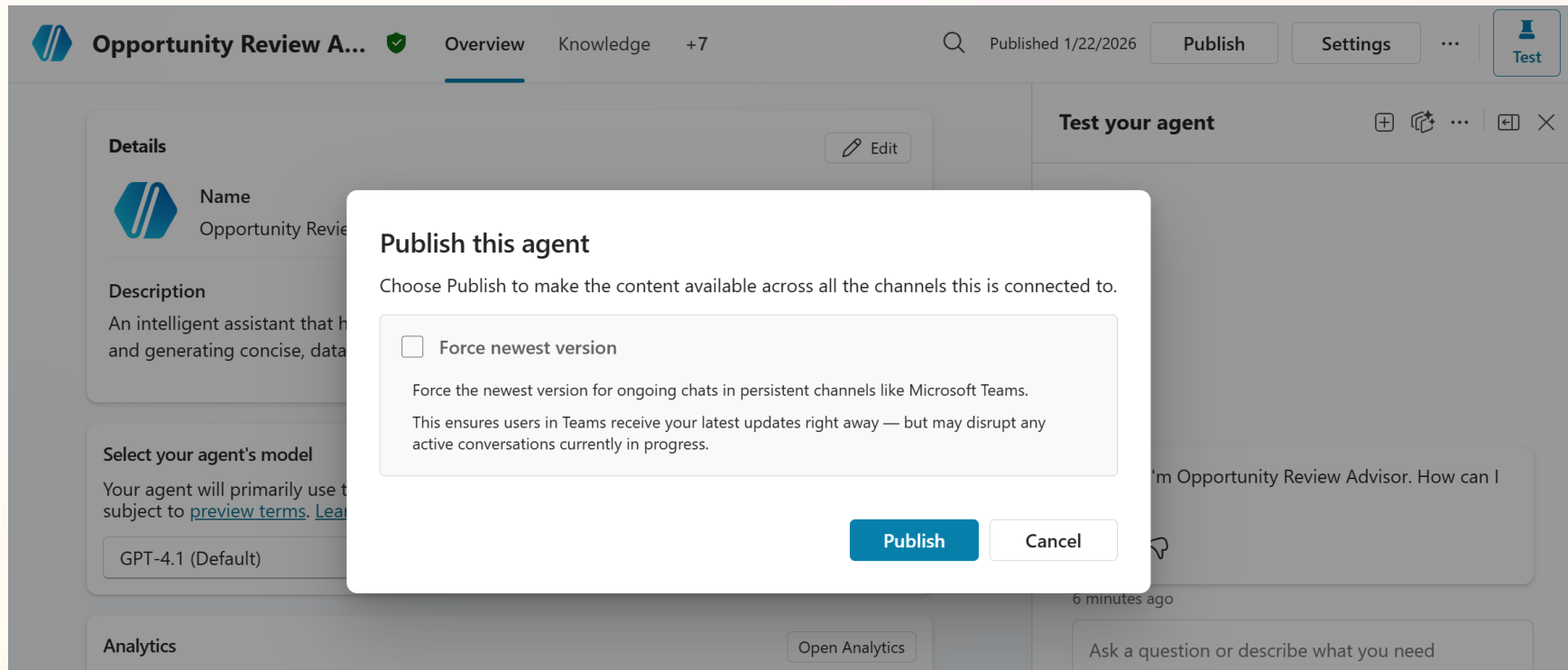
Authenticate with Microsoft



Authenticate manually

Publish

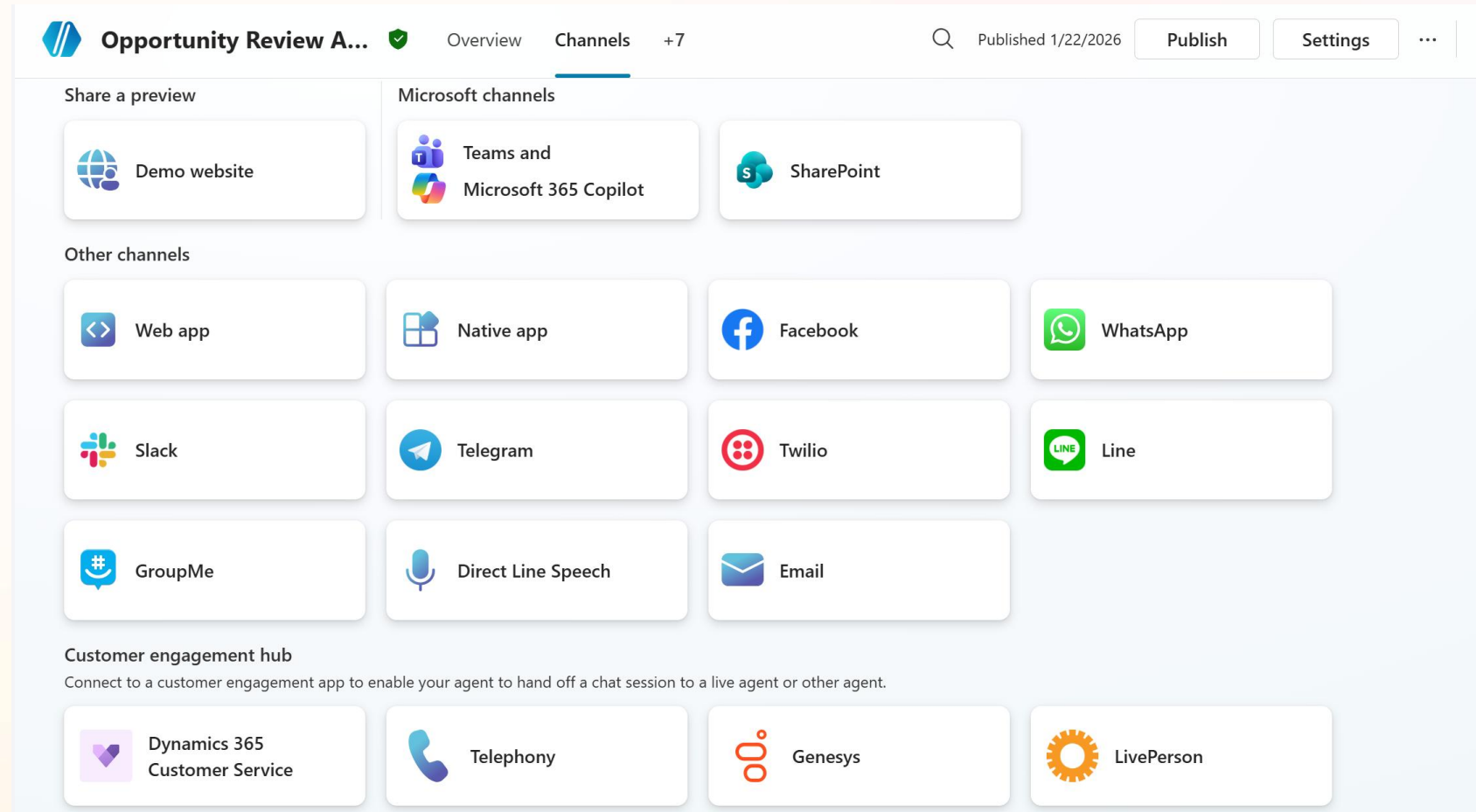
- Share with others
- Demo website
- Make the agent available on channels



Deploy

Channels

- Options to control the appearance of the agent
- Controls how a user can install the agent into a Microsoft Teams team



Manage Copilot Studio capacity and usage

- 1 Purchase Copilot Credit capacity

- 2 Manage billing plans

- 3 Manage Copilot Credits

- 4 View legacy session capacity

- 5 View or download usage reports

Calculate how much you've saved your org

Use the built-in savings calculator to estimate your business impact



Calculate savings

Calculate time or cost savings compared to different methods for each agent run and/or tool used



Estimate impact

Estimate an agent's business impact, identify and prioritize successful agents, and track return on investment (ROI) over time

Savings ⓘ



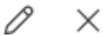
Time ⓘ

387 hrs ↑ 5%

Cost ⓘ

\$12,771 ↑ 8%

Savings



Get contacts from CRM

Use this tool to get contacts from the CRM

Time

13,013 hrs ↑ 60%

Get leads from CRM

Use this tool to get leads from the CRM

Time

490 hrs ↓ 93%

Practice Labs

Lab 1: Create agents with Copilot Studio

Summary

- Agents can be created manually, from a template, or by using natural language
- Generative AI can be used to build agents, orchestrate the agent, and answer questions
- An agent can use topics, tools, and knowledge to answer user queries
- Agents must be published to share with others and deploy to users



